

Cover Letter for Submission to Artificial Intelligence (AIJ)

Date: August 20, 2026

To: Editors-in-Chief and Associate Editors, *Artificial Intelligence* (Elsevier)

Title: *StateShift: Tracking State-Dependent Reasoning Recovery Across Post-Training*

Dear Editors,

We submit our manuscript entitled **StateShift: Tracking State-Dependent Reasoning Recovery Across Post-Training** for consideration as a Full-Length Research Article in *Artificial Intelligence*.

StateShift introduces a controlled framework for measuring target-transition recovery conditional on intermediate reasoning state.

Sincerely,

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